



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*sa kṛtvā bālarūpaṃ tu devadevaḥ svayaṃ śivaḥ |
krīḍāhetoḥ saromadhye grāhagrasto 'bhavattadā || 31 ||
yogamāyāmathāsthāya prapañcodbhavaakāraṇam |
tadrūpaṃ saraso madhye kṛtvedaṃ samabhāṣata |
trātu mām kaścidetyeha grāheṇa hṛtacetasaṃ || 32 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 12, Verses 31-32

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Skandapurāṇa unveils a profound truth about the divine play, the Lila of Shiva. Here, Shiva, the God of Gods, takes the form of a child, not out of simple amusement, but to enact a crucial teaching. He allows himself to be seized by a crocodile in a lake. This isn't a display of weakness, but a demonstration of Yogamaya, the divine illusion that veils the ultimate reality and is the very cause of the manifested universe. He deliberately creates this scenario, embodying helplessness, crying out for salvation from the jaws of the crocodile that has robbed him of his senses. "Save me," he pleads, "someone save me from this crocodile who steals my awareness."

This seemingly simple story is rich with symbolism for your own life. The crocodile represents the powerful forces that grip your mind – your fears, your attachments, your ego, all those aspects that cloud your perception of the divine within. Like the child Shiva, you too often find yourself caught in the jaws of these forces, feeling lost, helpless, and disconnected from your true Self. The lake represents the ocean of samsara, the cycle of birth, death, and rebirth, filled with both opportunities and dangers.

Shiva's call for help isn't a sign of inadequacy, but an invitation. It's an invitation for you to recognize your own vulnerability and to seek refuge in the divine. It's a reminder that you don't have to face these challenges alone. Just as Shiva calls out, you too can call upon the divine, whether you call it Shiva, God, Source, or the Universe. This call, born from genuine humility and a yearning for liberation, is the first step towards breaking free from the crocodile's grasp. The story reminds you that even when seemingly lost and overwhelmed, the divine is present, both within you and as the potential rescuer. By acknowledging your struggles and seeking divine grace, you can transcend the illusion of separation and realize your inherent divinity. This is the essence of devotion and the path to liberation from the cycles of suffering.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Where in your life are you being "eaten" by the "crocodile" of your own mind, and what form will your call for help take today?